

INTERNAL AUDITING MEMORANDUM

Linksys Global Customer Advocacy & Quality Assurance

TO: Linksys Global Operations, Tier 1 & Tier 2 Support, and QA Training Teams

FROM: Office of the Senior Director of Customer Advocacy & Senior Quality Assurance Specialist

DATE: June 4, 2026

SUBJECT: **CRITICAL CASE AUDIT & PERFORMANCE REDIRECT – Ticket #127492 (Richard Stell)**

AUDIT VERDICT

CRITICAL FAILURE / UNACCEPTABLE HANDOVER

EXECUTIVE DIRECTIVE & MISSION FOCUS

Team, our mission is simple: **Make Linksys Tech Support agents the absolute best, most excellent engineers in the industry.** What occurred in Ticket #127492 is the exact antithesis of excellence. We transformed a premium customer into an adversarial, 80-year-old critic threatening legal action because of our own internal process failures.

This audit exposes a culture of metric manipulation over genuine problem resolution. Below is the official, unfiltered breakdown of what this report got right, where our teams failed, and the structural upgrades we are implementing immediately to retrain our frontline and escalation tiers.

THE GOOD: HIGH-VALUE INSIGHTS FROM THE AUDIT

The analytical framework provided in the ticket analysis report is highly valuable for leadership because it isolates exactly where our workflow broke down:

- **Forensic Visibility on "Ticket Churn":** The report accurately identifies a systemic pattern of premature ticket closures. It highlights how agents prioritize clearing their queues over verifying long-term device stability.
- **The Technical Catch Recognition:** The report properly commends Tier 1 agent Aysah Bagumbaran for documenting a critical technical bottleneck—the **-76 dBm RSSI reading** on Child Node 2. This demonstrates the report's value in isolating actionable technical data points that subsequent agents ignored.
- **Uncompromising Accountability:** It correctly targets the internal meeting conflict with Team Lead Marc and Operations Manager Joey as an invalid reason for breaking a committed customer callback window.

THE BAD: PROCESS DEVIATIONS & TECHNICAL PITFALLS

The findings within this ticket reveal a severe deviation from Linksys standard operating procedures. Review these specific failure points to ensure they are never repeated:

1. The "Observe and Close" KPI Trap

- **Premature Resolutions:** Multiple Tier 1 agents (Jorge Nathan, Riojene, and Girlyjoy) repeatedly marked the ticket "Resolved" after basic steps or after telling the customer to "observe for an hour." Closing a ticket without a confirmed fix is a data integrity and quality violation.
- **Deflecting Work:** Directing an active, bleeding customer to "call us back later" when their system is dropping every 5 minutes is entirely unacceptable.

2. Failure to Establish a Technical Baseline

- **Topology Chaos:** Agents documented completely conflicting node counts (ranging from 3, 6, 8, to 11 nodes) across different sessions without ever reconciling the actual hardware layout. Trying to troubleshoot an 11-node mixed environment (MX4200 and legacy WHW03) blindly is impossible.
- **Unjustified Hardware Recommendations:** A previous agent advised the customer to buy a brand-new modem without documenting any technical justification or data to support the recommendation. The customer spent money on hardware that did not fix the problem.
- **Skipping Fundamental Diagnostics:** Level 2 specialist Eric Marbella noted weeks into the escalation chain that a basic **wired bypass test** (connecting an iMac directly to the AT&T gateway via Ethernet) *had still never been attempted*.

3. Absolute Breakdown of Callback Discipline

- Tier 2 support broke four separate callback commitments. Promising a frustrated customer an urgent 30-minute callback and leaving them stranded for hours is a critical failure.

DIRECTOR'S OPERATIONAL DIRECTIVE:

No internal meeting, huddle, or training session takes priority over a committed customer callback window. If an agent is pulled into an internal meeting, leadership must ensure active queue coverage.

THE IMPROVED: ACTIONABLE TRAINING UPGRADES

To maximize the training value of this case file and elevate our agent handling to an elite tier, we are upgrading our quality and technical frameworks across the following three pillars:

1. Implementation of the "Complex Environments" Technical Protocol

Any property logged as over **4,000 square feet** or utilizing **more than 4 mesh nodes** must immediately trigger a mandatory technical checklist for the agent:

- **Node Inventory Hard-Lock:** The agent must reconcile and log the exact model number, serial number, and physical placement of every single node before changing any settings.
- **Signal Strength (RSSI) Rules:** Agents must be trained that any node reporting an RSSI worse than **-65 dBm** requires physical relocation or topology re-evaluation. Aysah's -76 dBm discovery should have halted standard software troubleshooting until the node was moved.
- **Mandatory Wired Isolation:** For intermittent drops, a direct-to-modem wired bypass test must be conducted during the very first escalation session to isolate the true fault domain.

2. Re-Engineering the Ticket Lifecycle Rules

- **Ban Single-Sided Closures:** Agents are strictly prohibited from closing a ticket under a status of "Observe." If a network requires monitoring, the case must be set to a pending state with a mandatory, timed outbound task assigned to that specific agent.
- **Multi-Node Stability Period:** For network topologies containing 4 or more nodes, a case cannot be marked "Resolved" until the customer confirms stable connectivity, or automated telemetry verifies 48 hours of uninterrupted uptime.

3. High-Risk Customer Escalation Path

- **Legal & Escalation Alerts:** The moment a customer explicitly requests management or mentions legal remedies, the case must bypass standard Tier 1/Tier 2 workflows.
- **Executive Advocacy Routing:** These tickets must route directly to an Executive Advocacy or Customer Relations squad. Frontline agents must be trained to warm-transfer these interactions immediately rather than attempting to log-and-consult internally.

IMMEDIATE CORRECTIVE ACTION PLAN

1. **Executive Outreach:** Operations Management is personally contacting Richard Stell today to de-escalate, apologize for the broken commitments, and take direct ownership of the relationship.
2. **Dedicated End-to-End Case Ownership:** This case is stripped from the shared queue. A single, designated Tier 2 Senior Engineer will own the problem end-to-end until full stability is verified or an RMA is processed.
3. **Mandatory QA Workshop:** This case study will be stripped of identifying employee data and utilized as a mandatory training module for all teams to reinforce technical baseline requirements and callback compliance.

Let's use this breakdown to fix this network, restore this customer's faith in our brand, and drastically elevate our technical support standards.